

Nutriment-born materiality (*āhāra-ja-rūpa*) comprises two types of kalāpa born of nutriment:

- 1) Nutriment-born pure octad kalāpa (*āhāra-ja-suddh-aṭṭhaka-kalāpa*): it comprises the basic eight types of materiality, the eighth here being nutriment-born nutritive essence (*āhāra-ja-ojā*). Hence, it is also called nutriment-born nutritive-essence octad-kalāpas (*āhāra-ja-oj-aṭṭhamaka-kalāpa*): it is concrete materiality.
- 2) Lightness, etc. undecad-kalāpa (*lahut-ād-ekā-dasaka-kalāpa*): it comprises the basic eight plus three more types of materiality: lightness (*lahutā*), softness (*mudutā*), and wieldiness (*kammaññatā*). It arises when the body feels comfortable and light, because of happiness, health, strength, comfort, etc.: for example, if our digestion is very good, these nutriment-born nutritive-essence kalāpas spread very easily. The same thing may happen if the food is wholesome and delicious.

These two types of nutriment-born materiality are produced in the two-fold process of nutrition: when the body is nourished by the nutriment from food and drink. How?

The body gets nutriment from the food and drink in our alimentary canal: the food and drink in our mouth, newly taken undigested food and drink in our stomach,² semi-digested- and fully digested food in our intestines, and faeces. All that is temperature-born nutritive-essence octad-kalāpas (*utu-ja-oj-aṭṭhamaka-kalāpa*), the same as the food in our bowl. And the nutritive-essence of those kalāpas nourishes the body chiefly with the help of the digestive fire (*pācaka-tejo*): the fire element of the life-nonad kalāpas, which (as mentioned) are kamma-born, and found throughout the body.

There are then two stages of nutrition. The first stage takes place when the digestive fire meets with the nutritive essence of the food in our alimentary canal. By that meeting, further materiality is generated throughout the body: that is, nutriment-born nutritive-essence octad-kalāpas (*āhāra-ja-oj-aṭṭhamaka-kalāpa*) are generated throughout the body.

The second stage of nutrition is when the digestive fire meets with the nutritive-essence of those nutriment-born nutritive-essence octad-kalāpas as well as the nutritive-essence of other materiality of the body. By that meeting, yet further materiality is generated; that is, yet other nutriment-born nutritive-essence octad-kalāpas.³

- four to five generations in the case of kamma-born materiality
- two to three generations in the case of consciousness-born materiality
- ten to twelve generations in the case of temperature-born materiality
- ten to twelve generations in the case of other nutriment-born materiality

That is how the nutriment from food and drink nourishes the body.

For example, in the first stage of nutrition, a nutriment-born nutritive-essence octad-kalāpa reaches the eye. Then, in the second stage, the nutritive-essence of such a nutriment-born nutritive-essence octad-kalāpa (together with the digestive fire) meets with the nutritive-essence of an eye-decad kalāpa, and four to five generations of nutriment-born nutritive-essence octad-kalāpas are generated: the nutriment-born nutritive-essence octad-kalāpa and the life-nonad kalāpa function as supporting cause (*upatthambhaka-paccaya*), and the eye decad-kalāpa functions as productive cause (*janaka-paccaya*). And again, the fire element in those four to five generations of nutriment-born nutritive-essence octad-kalāpas generates ten to twelve generations of temperature-born nutritive-essence octad-kalāpas. And this same process takes place with the body decad-kalāpas of the eye, sex decad-kalāpas of the eye, as well as consciousness-born octad-kalāpas, life nonad-kalāpas, and other nutriment-born octad-kalāpas. That is how the nutriment from food and drink nourishes, for example, the eye.

The nutriment of food taken in one day may regenerate in this way for up to seven days. But the number of generations depends on our digestive power, which is determined by our own kamma. It depends also on the quality of the food. If the food is poor, it cannot generate many generations, and we become weak and thin. If the food is rich, it can generate many generations, and we may even become fat. Divine nutriment, most superior nutriment of the deva-world, may regenerate this way for up to one or two months.

Since life nonad-kalāpas are found throughout the body, the digestive fire is found to a weaker degree throughout the body. That is why, for example, when medicinal oil is applied to the skin, or an injection of medicine is made under the skin, the medicine spreads throughout the body (the first stage of nutrition). But if very much oil is applied, the weakness of the digestive fire in the skin may mean it takes longer to absorb. The medicine then takes effect when it goes through the second stage of nutrition.

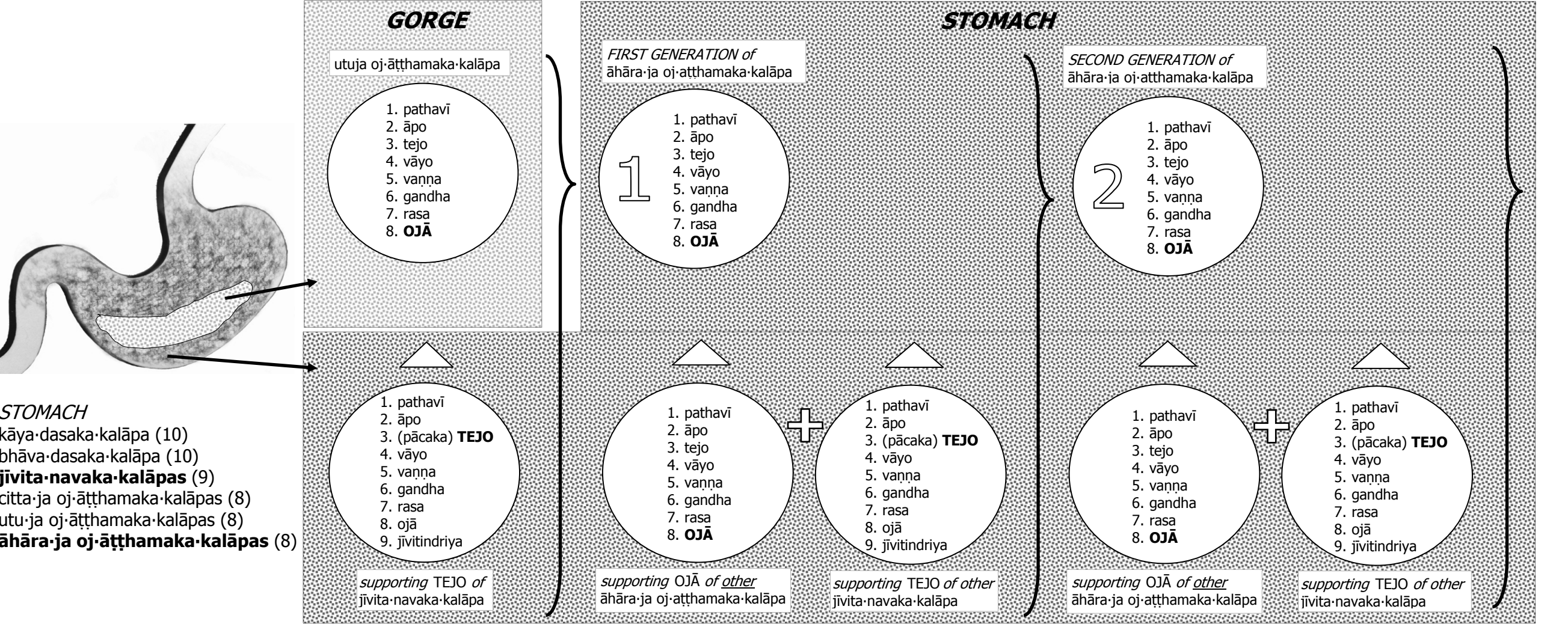
To know and see materiality for the practice of insight, we need to know and see both stages of nutrition: the first stage by which nutriment-born nutritive-essence octad-kalāpas are generated and spread to the various parts of the body, and the second stage by which yet other generations of nutritive-essence octad kalāpas are generated to nourish the various parts of the body.

¹ This explanation has been taken from *The Workings of Kamma* by the Pa-Auk Tawya Sayadaw, pp.100-101.

² As a part of the body, this is called gorge.

³ The materiality produced in the first stage is called nutriment-originated materiality (*āhāra-samutṭhāna-rūpa*). In the second stage, for kamma-born materiality, the first generation is kamma-caused nutriment-born materiality (*kamma-paccay-āhāra-ja-rūpa*), whereas the following generations are nutriment-caused nutriment-born materiality (*āhāra-paccay-āhāra-ja-rūpa*): also called nutriment-caused nutriment-originated materiality (*āhāra-paccaya āhāra-samutṭhāna-rūpa*). In the same way, there is consciousness- and temperature-caused nutriment-born materiality.

REGENERATION OF NUTRIMENT-BORN KALĀPAS FROM THE GORGE (undigested food) IN THE STOMACH



STOMACH
kāya-dasaka-kalāpa (10)
bhāva-dasaka-kalāpa (10)
jīvita-navaka-kalāpas (9)
citta-ja oj-ātthamaka-kalāpas (8)
utu-ja oj-ātthamaka-kalāpas (8)
āhāra-ja oj-ātthamaka-kalāpas (8)

